

Derek Merrikin

Senior Full-Stack Engineer · Technical Team Lead · UI/UX
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SUMMARY

AWS Certified Senior Engineer and Technical Lead with 14+ years delivering production systems across fintech, healthcare, and e-commerce. Expert in React, TypeScript, and Node.js, with deep experience in cloud infrastructure, containerization, and team leadership. Track record of owning features end-to-end, setting architectural direction, and raising the bar on engineering quality without needing PM support. U.S. Citizen, eligible and willing to obtain a Secret Security Clearance.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Frontend: React, TypeScript, Next.js, Redux, Angular, GraphQL, Tailwind, SCSS/SASS, HTML5, CSS3, Jest, Playwright, Webpack, Chrome Extensions

Backend: Node.js, Express, PHP (11 yrs), Python, Ruby on Rails, PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, RabbitMQ, Stripe, REST APIs

Infrastructure & DevOps: AWS (EC2, S3, Lambda, Kubernetes), Azure DevOps, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD, Vercel, Datadog, Git, Bash

AI & Other: OpenAI GPT-4/3.5, Function Calling, JWT, OAuth, 2FA, WCAG AA, Agile/Scrum, Jira, WordPress

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer / Interim Dev Lead | Eliassen Group (FM Global) — Remote

Dec 2024 – Present

- Interim development lead owning Azure DevOps pipelines, configurations, and release management end-to-end.
- Architected a scalable micro front-end system in NX Framework with reusable component patterns for independent enterprise deployments.
- Built and maintained GraphQL hooks powering real-time transactional financial interfaces, enforcing 80%+ Jest unit test coverage across the team.
- Optimized ArcGIS/ESRI map loading performance by rearchitecting component lifecycle with useEffect, enabling static landing-page load and deferred interactive maps from cache.

Team Lead & Senior Software Engineer | GraVoc — Peabody, MA (Hybrid)

Jul – Oct 2024

- Led two concurrent full-stack teams (MERN/GRAND and LAMP) across all 8 of the company's high-revenue client projects with no PM support.
- Migrated flagship MERN application to GRAND stack end-to-end, introduced Jest unit testing, and stood up GitHub Actions YAML deployment pipelines from scratch.
- Automated infrastructure logging via Lambda + CloudWatch to S3 JSON pipeline, mentored engineers, and drove cross-team knowledge sharing.

Technical Team Lead & Senior Software Engineer | Easton Consulting Technologies — Remote

Sep 2023 – Apr 2024

- Led SRE team overseeing 7+ web products handling \$250K+/hour in e-commerce traffic, acting as primary technical contact for the VP of Technology and CEO.
- Full rewrite of Voyage Market in React, Next.js, and Node.js, plus launched three additional redesigned sites (Rocket21Challenge, Fortunes Funding, The Funded Trader).
- Enforced 2FA across all production properties, ran rigorous PR reviews, and kept Agile delivery on track across a distributed team.

Senior Software Engineer | Built Technologies — Nashville, TN (Remote)

Jan – Jul 2023

- Developed React components within AWS Cloud9/Kubernetes microservice architecture, integrated OAuth, and ensured WCAG AA accessibility compliance.
- Pushed Jest test coverage improvements across the microservice architecture, contributed to the Go-based CI/CD pipeline, and used Datadog to track down production issues.
- Go-to resource for the team on a complex PHP codebase, providing architectural guidance and code review across the engineering org.

Software Engineer | DEPT — Boston, MA

Mar 2021 – Oct 2022

- Built reusable React and Angular components for fintech and crypto clients, including a white-label branding platform in React and Next.js.
- Implemented JWT auth across Angular and React apps, delivered E2E tests with Cypress, and maintained WCAG AA standards throughout.
- Used SQL and NoSQL Firebase databases within a CI/CD pipeline supporting fast iterative design changes.

Senior UI/UX Developer | Fresenius Medical Care — Lexington, MA

Dec 2015 – Mar 2021

- Built a custom Node.js crawler to migrate 80,000 documents and 5,000 pages from Oracle UCM into WordPress via REST API, and resolved security vulnerabilities flagged through pen testing.
- Designed and built a hybrid full-stack solution using WordPress as the backend with Angular front-end rendering, including Microsoft Active Directory SSO integration.

Senior UI/UX Developer | Fidelity Investments — Smithfield, RI

Jul 2014 – Nov 2015

- Developed a white-label wizard for branded sales demos and built a full-stack MEAN solution for an Executive VP to manage business data.

UI/UX Developer | Medullan — Cambridge, MA

Jun 2013 – May 2014

- Built scalable WCAG AA-compliant healthcare portals for major insurance agencies, plus custom WordPress solutions tailored to client needs.

Junior Software Engineer | Mercer — Dedham, MA

Dec 2012 – Jun 2013

- Built end-to-end user experiences using KnockoutJS and jQuery in a professional services environment.

Co-Founder & Lead Developer | Pixelburst Studio, LLC — Remote

2006 – Present

- Co-own and operate a boutique web development studio serving small businesses across New England.
- Design and build client websites using WordPress, custom HTML/CSS/JS, and modern frontend tooling, handling everything from scoping to launch.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner · Valid Jul 2025 – Jul 2028

B.A. Computer Science · Southern New Hampshire University, 2020